Glenn McGrath would bowl you a half-volley only once a month. As far as line and length were concerned, he was the most disciplined bowler I have ever faced. You knew you weren't ever going to get a bad ball from him. I mean, the concept of a half-volley outside off-stump was totally alien to him.

McGrath hardly ever bowled bouncers either – he wasn't exactly express pace, especially towards the end of his career, but when he sent a bouncer your way, it always took you by surprise. However, his great strength was definitely his nagging accuracy. McGrath wasn't really interested in bowling you out or going for the leg-before, and he hardly ever went for the stumps. His game was to get you caught behind.

He was able to get the ball to do just that little bit off the seam that would get you to play and nick. There was never any great sideways movement, which you could either leave or would just be unplayable. Nope, McGrath always pitched in the channel outside off-stump, just back of a length, which invariably got you coming forward and, too often, nicking the ball to be caught behind.

Because of his immaculate length and the fact that he hardly ever pitched it up or bowled a yorker, you could actually leave him more on length. Pitching outside off and back of a length meant that getting bowled or out lbw was not much of a threat.

McGrath wasn't shy to have a few words out there either … and unlike most other Aussies, he could get personal. He really had a go at me about the whole match-fixing saga while I was batting in a Test in Melbourne in 2004. He went on and on, saying, 'Hersch, how much did Hansie give you … 10 per cent?' For the first and probably only time in an international match, sledging got to me, and I lost my marbles a bit. I said, 'Just fuck off and bowl.'

Ja, McGrath loved to chat. He was always talking, under his breath a lot of the time, and if he could see he was getting to you, he wouldn't stop.

Wasim Akram

In his early days especially, Wasim was unplayable – fortunately I only faced him at the back-end of his career. Wasim was a really unorthodox bowler who'd come in off a short run-up but still whip the ball through, thanks to the incredible arm speed he'd generate. He also never had a big jump in his delivery action, and that jump actually helps a batsman get in